

ROBLOX BUSINESS · JUSTIN & HUNTER · V1.5

The Look Bar

How to make a same-day slice look like it belongs next to the games that hold kids — without asking Cube 3D or Studio MCP to be a AAA art department.

Your guess is correct. The MCP server and Studio Assistant do not produce the look of Grow a Garden, Bee Swarm, or Mine a Mountain. They produce usable props, fast. Top games look expensive because of five cheap decisions applied consistently: a five-line style spec, a lighting rig, a dressed destination, a readable collectable, and a thumbnail that works at 200px. Meshes are maybe twenty percent of that.

The 80 / 15 / 5 split

80% of the look is volume + light. Creator Store packs that share one silhouette language, plus a locked lighting / atmosphere / color-correction rig. This is free and first-party.

15% is three to five hero objects generated outside Studio (or with Cube under a triangle cap and a reference image), then forced onto the same colour logic.

5% is the icon and thumbnail. This is the #1 click lever. Do not generate it in MCP. Generate it in an image tool against the thumbnail formula, then G4.

PART 0 · WHAT "GOOD" ACTUALLY IS ON THIS PLATFORM

Kids do not compare triangle counts. They compare readability.

A ten-year-old on a phone sees a 200px tile, then a first minute. If the collectable does not read, the destination is not a building, the bag meter is one of four HUD numbers, and the light is Studio default, they leave. That is the look problem. It is not "our meshes are worse than theirs." Most #1s are low-poly, single-colour objects on a dark or simple ground with one accent and one light event. Grow a Garden's power is offline-respect plus Saturday appointments plus a gift surface — the art supports that, it does not replace it.

WHAT KIDS REGISTER IN 3 SECONDS	WHAT STUDIOS WASTE WEEKS ON
One giant collectable they can name	Unique trim on every bench
Where to walk (the bank / plot / hive is a building)	PBR on background rocks
One meter that is filling	A fourth HUD counter
Warm light toward something good, or a flood/event as the light source	Default Lighting, no Atmosphere, no ColorCorrection
Thumbnail: one face, one object, ≤3 words, high contrast	A screenshot of the grey box, or a busy collage
Everything the same colour family	Store assets from ten different styles dumped in a row

PART 1 · TOOL MAP — BEST TOOL WINS

MCP is a hand in Studio. It is not the art department.

v1.2 already said this and then under-specified it. Studio Assistant / Cube 3D / MCP mesh gen is free, first-party, and good at one job: a low-poly prop that fits a bounding box and a triangle cap. It is bad at hero collectables, faces, thumbnails, and anything you describe in a paragraph. Over-detailing the prompt makes Cube worse — that is the 2026 working knowledge, not a guess. Short prompt, reference image, triangle cap, accept 75% and paint it with the style spec.

JOB	BEST TOOL	DO NOT USE
Trees, stalls, benches, vault silhouette, coin piles, fountain — volume	Creator Store, searched by silhouette, inserted by ID. Free, licensed.	Cube for every tree. You will get twelve styles.
Hero collectable (the coin, the fruit, the brainrot, the bar of gold)	Image-to-3D outside Studio (Meshy / Tripo / Imagine→3D) → remesh under 10–20k tris → SurfaceAppearance. Or Cube with a 3/4 reference image + triangle cap.	A paragraph-long Cube prompt. A ripped mesh.
Destination building (bank, hive, plot, cage)	One Store vault/building as the mass. Cube or primitives for a custom facade in the style spec colours.	A unique cathedral. Kids need a silhouette they can walk toward.
Materials / ground / gold trim	Studio Material Generator + one MaterialService palette. Same three colours everywhere.	A new material per prop.
Lighting, haze, saturation, event glow	Lighting + Atmosphere + ColorCorrection + Bloom + one PointLight on the destination. Future/Realistic if the slice is small.	Leaving defaults. This is the highest-leverage ten minutes in the whole look.
Icon 512 ² and thumb 1920×1080	Grok Imagine / Ideogram / Recraft, or a Roblox-native thumb tool. Formula locked. Readable at 200px.	MCP screenshot of the place. Cube cannot draw a face that wins a click.
SFX / loop	Creator Store licensed audio library. IDs in the pack.	"Free" audio named after another game. Fingerprinted.
When the 200px test fails twice	Talent Hub artist, one hero + one thumb, capped. Optional ≤\$10 image tool first.	Rebuilding the engine. Art is not an engine problem.

Triangle budgets, so generation does not tank phones: props 1–8k, hero collectable ≤15k, destination building ≤20k (Roblox import cap is 20k per mesh). Generate richer if you want, then remesh down. A dense AI export that looks good in the viewer and dies on a phone is not a look. It is a frame-time bomb.

PART 2 · THE FIVE-LINE STYLE SPEC

This is the document that makes mixed sources look like one game

Store packs plus Cube plus Meshy will look like a yard sale unless one page forbids that. The style spec is five lines, written in Wave 1, applied to every insert and every generate. Fat Man Gets Rich already has one. Every new title gets one before a single asset is inserted.

LINE	WHAT IT LOCKS	FMGR EXAMPLE
1. Silhouette language	Low-poly vs round-toy vs chisel. One.	Low-poly single-colour objects that read at 200px
2. Ground + accent	Two colours. Not a palette of twelve.	Gold on dark ground
3. Light source	What is bright, and why.	The flood is the light source
4. The one meter + the destination	What the eye tracks.	One big bag meter. The bank is a building you walk toward
5. Mood + countdown rule	Cheerful / threat / bedtime.	Cheerful, zero threat. The only countdown counts toward something good

Anything that violates a line is rejected at insert time, including a "better" Store pack. Consistency beats quality. A kid reads the place as one world or as junk.

PART 3 · SAME-DAY DRESSING RECIPE

What the style + shelf agent actually does in Wave 1 and Wave 4

MINUTE	ACTION	DONE LOOKS LIKE
0–20	Write the five lines from the 3–5 teardown style notes. Not from taste. From what the comps share.	games/<slug>/theme.md
20–50	Studio Toolbox search by silhouette, not by game name. Coin pile, vault, stall, tree pack, fountain, bench, lamp. Record IDs. Skip anything with an owned name in the title.	shelf.md — ≥12 model IDs, 4 audio IDs, all free/licensed
50–70	Lock the lighting rig in a reusable LightingSpec: ClockTime, Brightness, OutdoorAmbient, Atmosphere density/haze, ColorCorrection contrast/sat/tint, Bloom, one PointLight on the destination, event light for the flood/restock.	games/<slug>/lighting.md with exact numbers. Builder pastes it.
Wave 3, parallel	Hero collectable: one reference sheet (3/4 view, white or dark ground, style-spec colours). Generate 3 candidates. Pick one that reads at 200px. Remesh. Do not iterate ten times.	One MeshPart + SurfaceAppearance in the pack
Wave 4	Insert shelf by ID into tagged slots in world.luau. Recolor every insert to the two-colour spec. Hide anything that fights the silhouette. MCP screenshot spawn + destination + meter.	Place looks like the spec, not like a toolbox dump
Wave 4 end	Icon 512 and thumb 1920×1080 from the formula. One face (or one fat silhouette), one giant collectable, ≤3 words, high contrast, no owned IP.	G4 pair. Silence 30 min = ship

Lighting rig — the ten-minute upgrade MCP should apply to every slice

Default Studio lighting is why generated games look like generated games. On a small slice use Realistic / Future lighting, a ClockTime that matches the mood (golden hour for gold games), Atmosphere with enough haze that the far edge dies softly, ColorCorrection contrast +0.1 to +0.2 and saturation slightly up for kid games, Bloom only on emissive / gold / the event, and one warm PointLight at the bank so the destination reads from spawn. Put the numbers in lighting.md. Do not invent them each title.

Cube / Assistant — use it like a prop shop, not a studio

- Prompt short: "low poly gold coin pile, single colour, no text." Not a paragraph.
- Feed a reference image (3/4 view, clean ground). Official Assistant accepts image-to-mesh. Text+image together still fails — pick one.
- Select a Part as a bounding box first so scale is not a surprise.
- Set a max triangle count. Faceted is the style, not a defect.
- Build the body with primitives when Cube gets cute. Generate only the ornament (the gold face, the flood glow mesh).
- Accept ~75% and paint with MaterialService. A third regenerate is stalling.

PART 4 · LOOK BAR — PASS / FAIL BEFORE MCP

If this fails, the four-beat can still be green and the kid still leaves

CHECK	PASS
200px icon	The collectable is nameable at arm's length from the phone.
Spawn screenshot	You can point at the destination building without explaining.
Meter	Exactly one big number that is filling. Not four.
Palette	Two colours plus ground. A third only on the event.
Set dressing	No two adjacent Store packs from different decades / styles.

CHECK	PASS
Light	Default lighting is gone. Destination is the brightest thing that is not the event.
Audio	Pickup + bank + one loop, all Store IDs. No named-after-another-game files.
IP	No owned names, mascots, faces of existing characters. R6 is a block.

PART 5 · WHAT THIS COSTS, AND WHEN TO PAY

Stay on the \$0 path until the 200px test fails

v1.2 cost sheet still holds. Store, Cube, Assistant, MCP, native Experiments: free. Optional spend arrives only when a gate cares.

WHEN	SPEND	ON WHAT
Phase 1 / Gate A	\$0	Store + lighting rig + Cube props + one hero generate if a free/owned-tool tier covers it
G4, 200px test failed twice	≤ \$10 / month image tool, or Grok Imagine already in plan	Icon + thumb only. Not a new world
Hero collectable still unreadable after 3 Cube/Meshy tries	\$20–80 one mesh on Talent Hub or a Meshy/Tripo month if you will reuse the pipeline	One object. Not a set
After D1 clears and the thumb is the limiter	Talent Hub artist for the winning icon, then ads on that icon only	Do not buy traffic on a tile that lost the 200px test

PART 6 · STANDING ORDERS FOR THE STYLE AGENT

Paste under the swarm block in CLAUDE.md

LOOK BAR (v1.5)

- MCP / Cube / Assistant dress props. They do not own the look. Lighting + style spec + Store volume + one hero + one thumb own the look.
- Write five style lines before any insert. Reject inserts that fight the lines.
- Search the Store by silhouette, insert by ID, recolor to the two-colour spec. Never search by another game's name and take that pack as-is.
- Cube prompts stay short. Reference image or bounding box. Triangle cap. Third regenerate = stop and use primitives + paint.
- Apply the lighting rig from lighting.md before you call the place dressed.
- Icon and thumbnail are an image-tool job against the formula. Not a Studio screenshot.
- Look-bar checks run before MCP four-beat. A green loop in a default-lit toolbox dump is not Phase 1.
- Do not rip. Do not ship reference-board images as textures. Do not spend on art before the 200px test has failed twice — except the image-tool thumb if G4 is today.

For Fat Man Gets Rich, this week

You already have the five lines and a stocked shelf. The look work is not a new art direction. It is: Justin's three clicks so InsertService works, Builder wires IDs into world.luau / theme.luau, lighting rig lands, hero coin pile reads at 200px, flood is the light source, then MCP screenshots spawn + bank + meter. Icon/thumb after Gate A, not instead of it. Do not open a Meshy subscription to avoid the publish click.

Sources. Roblox Assistant /generate_mesh docs (image ref, bounding box, triangle cap, Sep 2026) · Creator Store · Lighting / Atmosphere / post-processing docs · v1.2 copy-aggressively shelf · v1.3 / v1.4 swarm · common 2026 thumbnail spec 512² / 1920×1080 · working reports that over-specified Cube prompts degrade output.